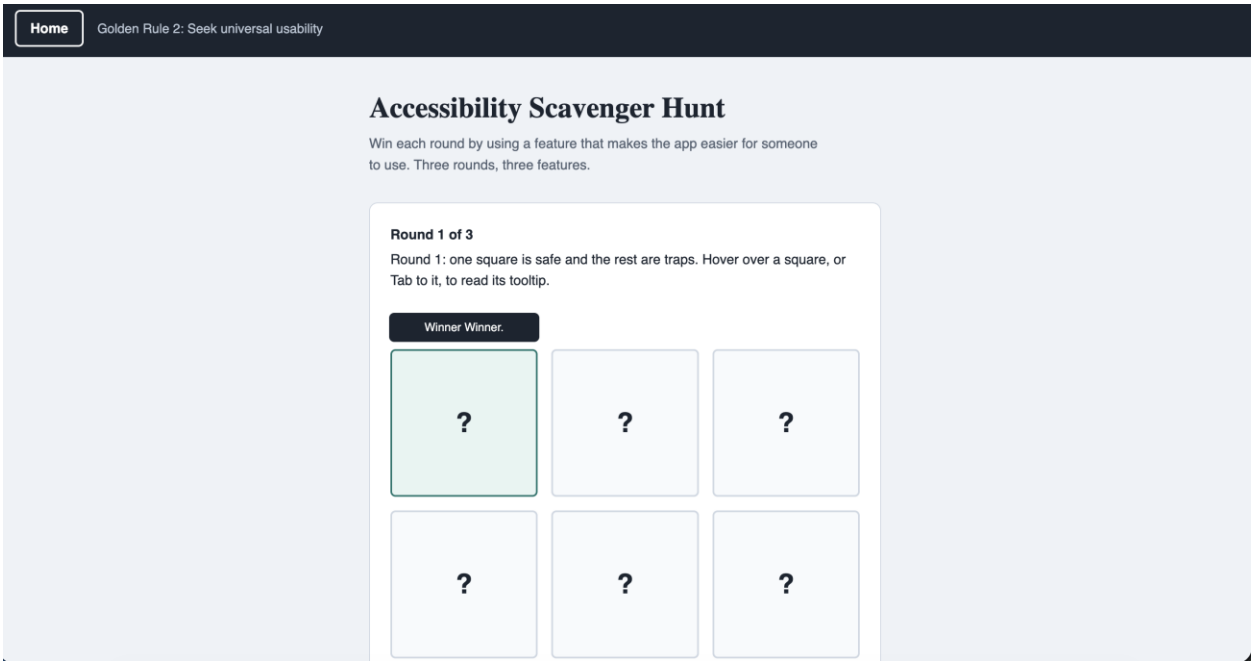
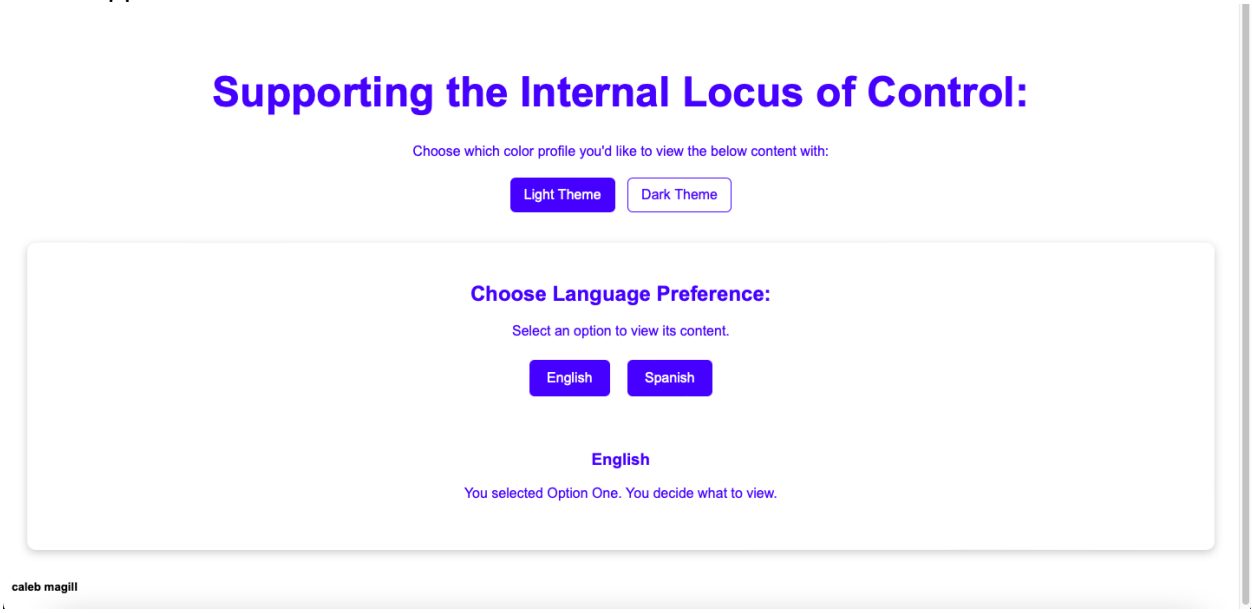
Rule: Seek Universal Usability



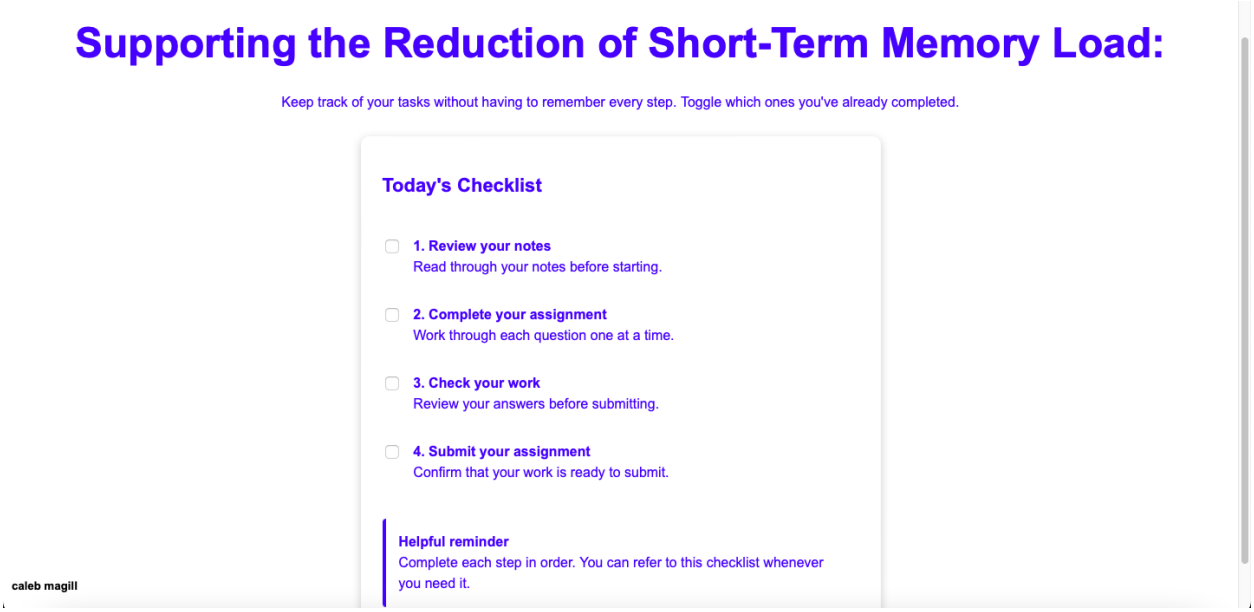
For this page, the user is meant to complete a three-round scavenger hunt, where each round is won by using a different accessibility feature. In Round 1, tooltips support newcomers by telling them what is under each square before they choose. The tooltips appear on keyboard focus as well as mouse hover, so they don't depend on a mouse. Round 2 supports users with low vision. The vault code is tiny and faint, and the "Larger text" and "High contrast" buttons make it readable, with each button announcing whether it is on or off. Round 3 supports novices and experts in the same task. Beginners can use the visible "Open door" button, while experts can press O (or press ? to see the shortcut list), and both paths lead to the same result. The page also includes supporting accessibility features throughout.

Rule: Support Internal Locus of Control



For this page, the user is meant to select their language preference to view the below content. In an attempt to support the user's internal locus of control, as much autonomy and power is given to the user in regard to how said application's content is displayed. Said locus of control is provably supported as, upon the user selecting their preference; for either the language or the theme to display it in, the content adapts to support the user's choice. The consistency of design is another feature that helps the user in transitioning from a previous page (the short-term memory load). The dialogue provided clearly communicates the nature of the options the user is presented with. Lastly, the implicit informative feedback; in the form of the appearance of the content changing, on clicking an option further conveys the actions the user has taken, and if they choose, can easily revert their choice.

Rule: Support Reduction of Short-Term Memory Load

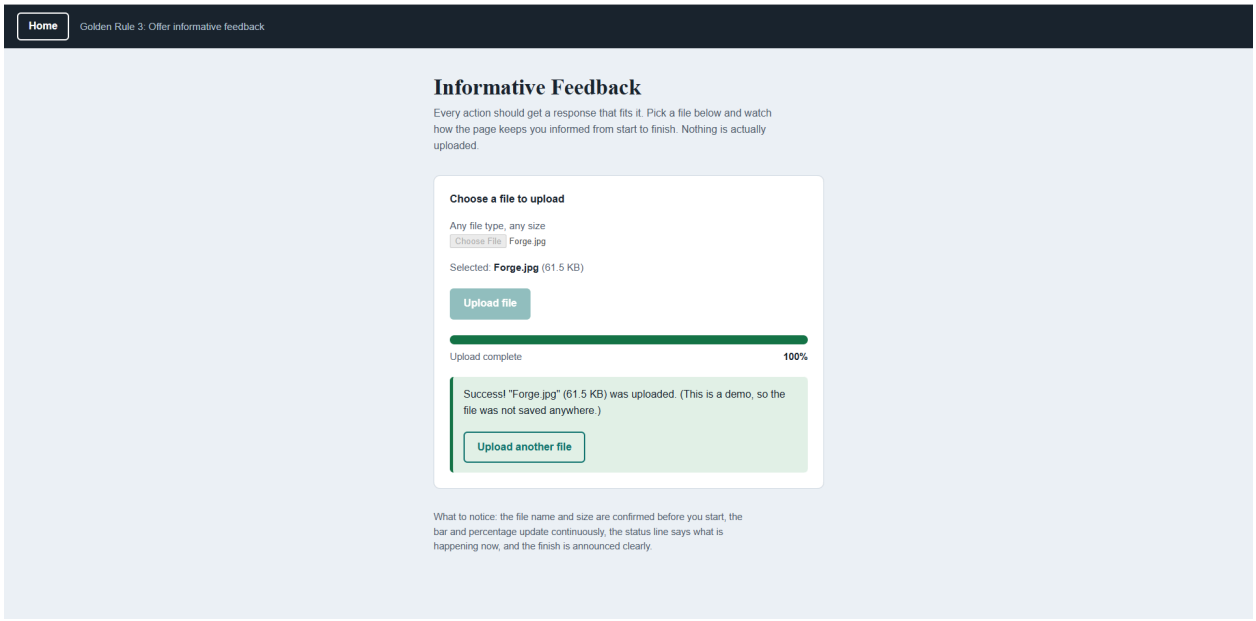


For this page, I took the approach of a tasks list; appearing as a checklist whereas the user can click which tasks they've already completed such to not have to recollect as to what has yet to be done. This supports the short-term memory of the user as they can be reminded what has still to be complete, being able to refer to the checklist at any point to remind themselves. Having checked a given task, the user can see clearly it is marked off, thus indicating they no longer have to recollect its completion. With the previous point, it additionally permits the reversal of actions, as a user may uncheck a given completed task. Additionally, as for further assistance to the user, a reminder at the bottom of the page is featured such to give informative dialogue to the user as to the nature of the page; that of course they can use it for future reference in the completion of a task.

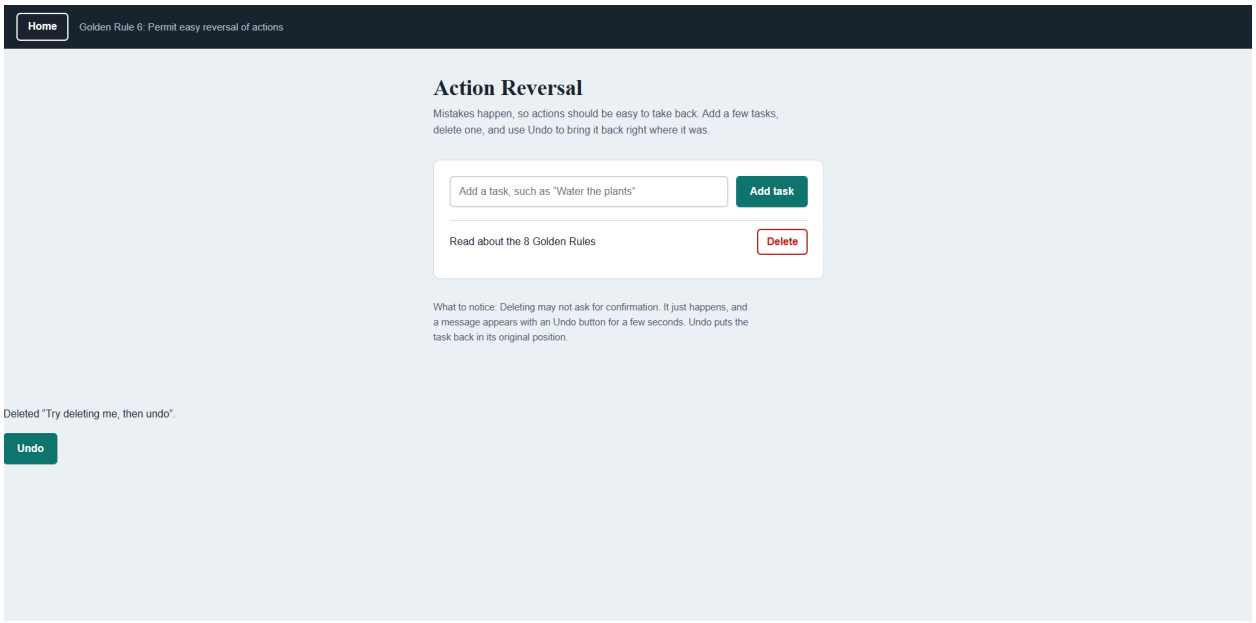
HIC Golden Rules 3 & 6 Documentation

Zachary Beatty

Due: 10/15/26



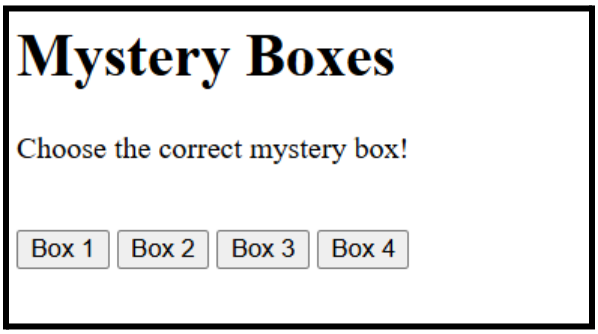
Golden Rule 3: Offer Informative Feedback: The purpose of this page is to demonstrate Golden Rule 3 by using a simple file upload. The user is prompted to upload a file and upon doing so the page shows the upload progress clearly. Once the upload is complete, a green box and a success message pops up to inform the user of the result. This explicitly demonstrates Rule 3 as accurate and updated information is being given to the user regarding their action.



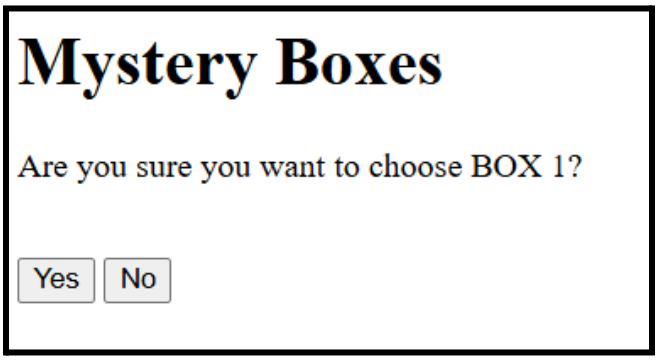
Golden Rule 6: Permit Easy Reversal of Actions: The purpose of this page is to demonstrate Golden Rule 6 by giving the user an interactive task list to play with. The user can add tasks and delete them. When deleting a task an undo button will appear near the bottom of the screen for a few seconds, allowing the user to undo their deletion for a set amount of time. This demonstrates Rule 6 by allowing the user to easily recover from mistakes.

Rule: Dialogue

Game:



→



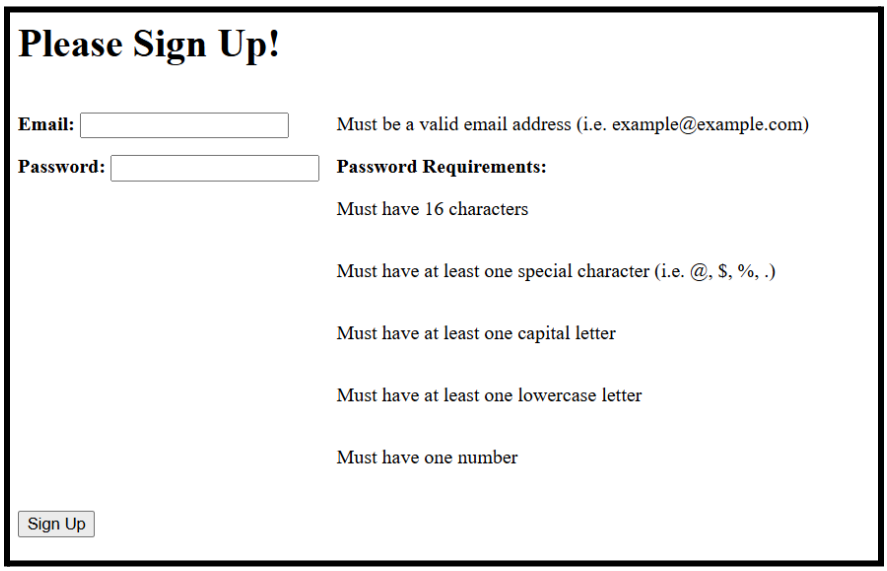
Possible Results:

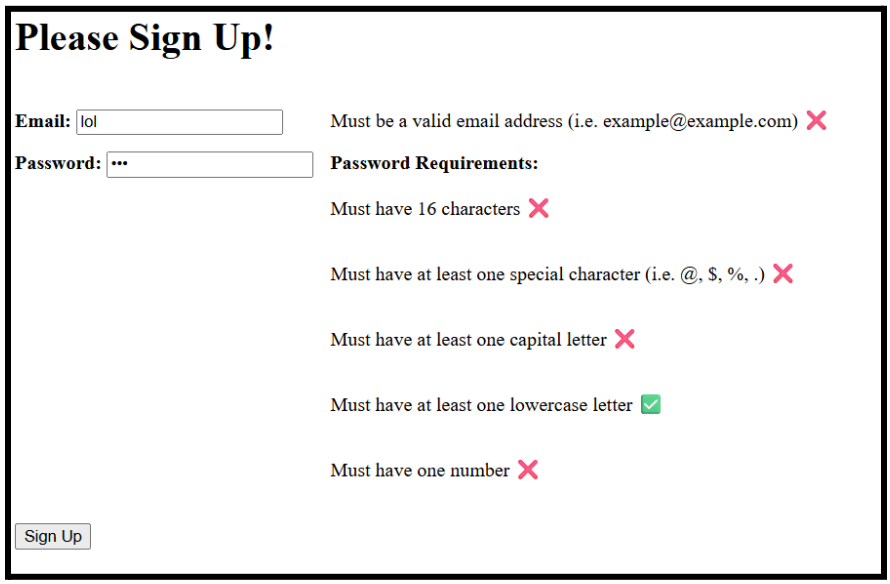


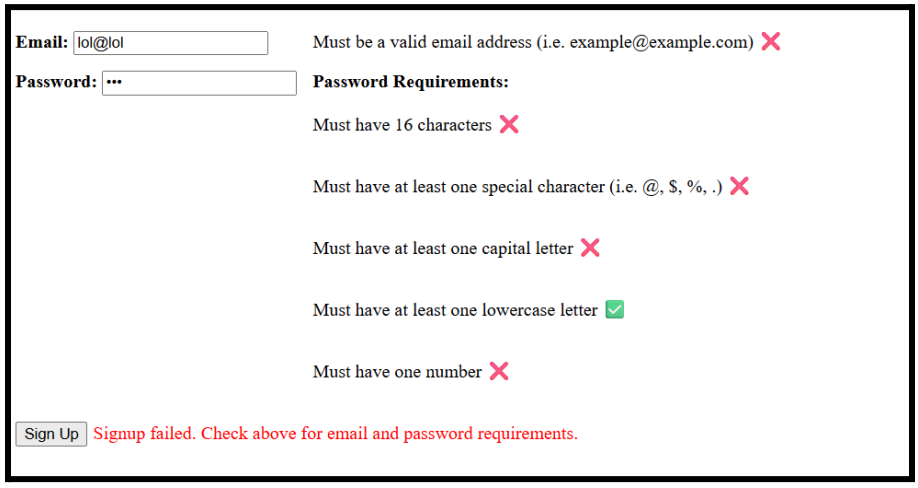


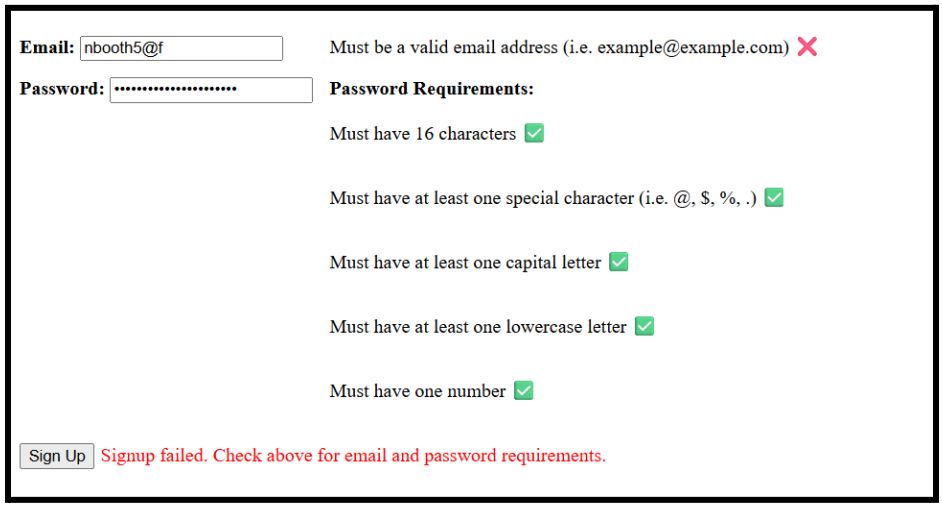
This page is a mystery box game where the user has four box choices. Once the user selects a box, a dialogue pops up to make sure the user wants to make the choice. Pressing “No” returns the user back to the initial prompt with no change in the winning box, while pressing “Yes” takes the user to either a win or lose page. Each of these pages is an informative dialogue showing the user if they won or lost the game, encouraging the player to try to win again on the win page or try again to win for the first time.

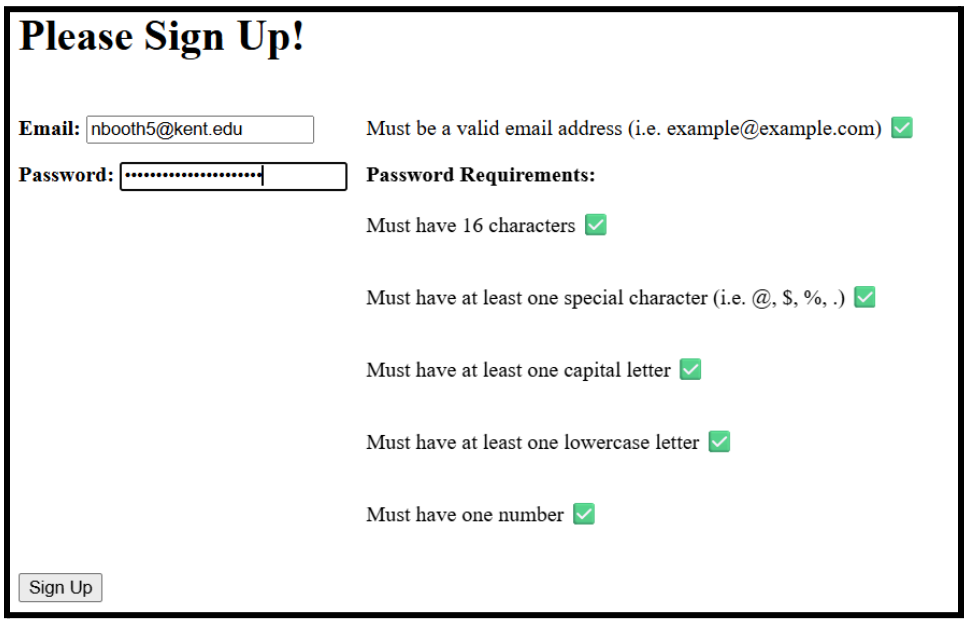
Rule: Error Handling











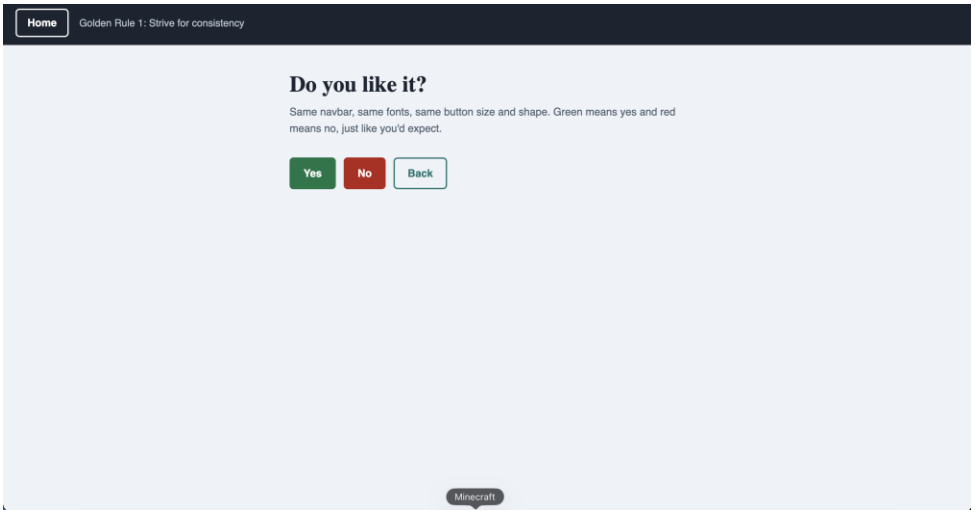


This page requires the user to sign up for an “account” following specific requirements for email and password to sign up. Once the user successfully

signs up, the user sees a congratulations dialogue! However, the user will see if there is an error, with emojis showing a requirement's status of satisfied or not. If the user clicks sign up before seeing a checkmark for each requirement, the user will see a red-text error message showing a failed sign-up.

Rule: Strive for Consistency





For this page, the user is meant to choose between a consistent and an inconsistent version of the same screen and compare how each one feels to use. The start screen and the consistent page share the same navbar, fonts, and button style. The consistent page keeps the color meanings people expect, with a green Yes and a red No of the same size and shape, and the “Back” button uses the same wording and style as the other buttons. The inconsistent page breaks each of these on purpose. Its navbar has a different color, its links use mismatched fonts and sizes, and the back option is worded two different ways (“go back?” and “Back”). The question’s buttons also reverse the usual color and size conventions, with a large red Yes and a small green No. The No button also jumps to a new spot with each of its first three clicks, and the prompts “Really?” and “Why not?” appear before the explanation. Because nothing on the page looks or behaves the same way twice, the user can’t predict what an element will do. This is the contrast that shows consistency supports the rule. Finally, the message shown after the user clicks Yes or No gives feedback that explains why the page felt easy or confusing.